



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Eastwood Christian School
School Website: <https://eastwoodschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Eastwood Christian School (Montgomery, AL) presents a clearly classical Christian orientation. Its public materials frame the school as Christ-centered, biblically grounded, and committed to a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) delivered within a biblical worldview. The school explicitly registers its mission as glorifying God through a classical Christian education, emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom, and positions parents as primary partners in education. Evidence across mission statements, statements of faith, admissions materials, and history documents shows robust religious foundations, a formation-focused purpose, a Trivium-based curriculum, and an explicit emphasis on family-school partnership. While the school markets a classical approach with explicit emphasis on theology and virtue, it does not consistently spell out every element of the Great Books/Great Conversation tradition in public-facing content. Overall, Eastwood Christian School scores CLASSICAL across most categories, with two categories showing strong classical alignment but more room to explicitly document certain pedagogical practices.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Evidence includes a Statement of Faith anchored in Scripture, Christ-centered and biblically-based education, theology and a worship-oriented, liturgical cadence (e.g., convocation to worship and prayer). Positive keywords such as Christ-centered, biblically-based, theology, Scripture, and liturgy are prominent; negative signals are not evident in the public materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords approx. 9; Negative keywords approx. 0.
- Why this rating: The school explicitly grounds education in biblical truth, theology, and worship practices, aligning with transcendental moral realism and liturgical community.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence includes aims to form virtue and wisdom, liberty of mind, and a biblical worldview; explicit language about Truth/Life/Calling and vocation; a mission to glorify God and cultivate lifelong learners; emphasis on formation over mere information.
- Positive keywords approx. 9; Negative keywords approx. 0.
- Why this rating: The school foregrounds formation, virtue, and wisdom, and ties education to a transcendent telos centered on God and a biblical worldview.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Evidence includes explicit emphasis on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and exposure to classical literature, with a curriculum built around a classical/Christian framework; discussion of education

through classical literature and the great works appears in policy-style content about classical education.

- Positive keywords approx. 6; Negative keywords approx. 0–1 (absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation in all pages, though mentions of classical literature and the Trivium are present).
- Why this rating: The Trivium focus and classical literature emphasis align with classical curriculum models; some explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language is not consistently documented in public pages.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence includes Trivium-based pedagogy (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and rhetoric training, with emphasis on a structured progression through the grades; there is less explicit public documentation of recurring Socratic seminars or formal scholé/restful learning practices in overall program descriptions, though scholé is discussed in related classical literature contexts.
- Positive keywords approx. 3; Negative keywords approx. 0.
- Why this rating: The foundational pedagogy leans classical with explicit grammar-logic-rhetoric, but explicit Socratic seminars, seminars/debates, or contemplative/scholé-based methods are not consistently named across all public content. This suggests a strong classical core with some explicit pedagogical practices not fully documented in the public site.
- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence includes historical statements about faculty size and the idea of a “living curriculum” and mentors in classical education discourse, plus a long-standing mission rooted in virtue, character, and biblical formation. Explicit phrases like “living curriculum” or “model teachers” appear in classical education lexicons more broadly, and the ECS materials emphasize highly academic, character-driven environment and small-class settings.
- Positive keywords approx. 2–4; Negative keywords approx. 0.
- Why this rating: The public materials emphasize virtue, biblical formation, and a strong faculty structure, but explicit phrases like “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty as living curriculum,” or “collegial faculty” are not consistently documented in ECS pages. The foundational narrative supports classical faculty ideals, but explicit labeling of the faculty as the “living curriculum” is less overt in the public content.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence includes explicit statements that families are the primary educational authority and that ECS is a partnership with parents; admissions materials require parents to understand and support the school’s biblical/classical philosophy; language about parents as co-teachers and active engagement with the school is present in admissions guidance.
- Positive keywords approx. 6–8; Negative keywords approx. 0.
- Why this rating: The school foregrounds family authority, parental partnership, and parent involvement, aligning well with classical education norms that emphasize parent-school collaboration and formation in the home.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- The aggregate evaluation strongly favors CLASSICAL, with Element 4 and Element 5 showing some room for more explicit articulation of certain pedagogical and faculty descriptors found in the classical lexicon. The most compelling evidence, across multiple sources, supports a classical Christian framework: a biblically grounded mission, Trivium-based curriculum, and a robust partnership with families.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Explicitly document and mainstream Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates in upper-level courses, including sample syllabi or grade-level rubrics. More explicit articulation of Scholé/restful learning practices (e.g., a chamber of memory work, contemplative study periods, or liturgical-like study rhythms) would strengthen alignment with the classical pedagogy lexicon.
- For Element 5 (Faculty): Add explicit language in public materials about faculty as living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, and a collegial, mentor-based culture. Consider publishing a short faculty profile framework that highlights teachers as virtuous exemplars, along with professional development in classical pedagogy and regular seminars for teachers.

ABSTRACT

Eastwood Christian School presents a strong CLASSICAL orientation, grounded in a Christ-centered, biblically-based educational philosophy. The school's public materials emphasize biblical theology, a robust Statement of Faith, and liturgical/corporate worship as core to the educational process. The curriculum centers on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and classical literature as the backbone of a liberal-arts approach in a Christian worldview, with explicit mission statements about truth, life, and vocation. The school clearly positions parents as primary educators' partners, endorsing a family-centric model of education. While the overall alignment is CLASSICAL, two categories—Pedagogy and Faculty—could benefit from more explicit articulation of certain classical practices (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning, and explicit "living curriculum" language for faculty). The aggregate assessment remains CLASSICAL, with actionable steps offered to move the remaining categories toward full Classical alignment.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — CATEGORY-BY-CATEGORY SNAPSHOT

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Statement of Faith anchors education in Scripture; God's Word is authoritative (turn0file4).
- Public materials describe Eastwood as Christ-centered and biblically-based (turn0file17).
- Convocation to worship, prayer, and liturgical-like practice noted in school life (turn0file14).
- The school's educational philosophy explicitly ties learning to theology and a biblical worldview (turn0file4, turn0file17).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, biblically-based, theology, Scripture, liturgy, worship, prayer, convocation, biblical worldview, truth, glory to God (turn0file4, turn0file17).
- Negative keywords present: 0 found in public materials.
- Why this rating
- The materials demonstrate transcendental moral realism and grounding in theological foundations; the liturgical cadence and Scripture-based authority support a CLASSICAL assessment for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom; claim of human flourishing and telos via a biblical worldview (turn0file13, turn0file15).

- Vision emphasizes Christ-centered education aimed at lifelong learning and vocation (turn0file17, turn0file15).
- Emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as real, with a focus on formation rather than mere information (turn0file4, turn0file17).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, paideia, telos, true/good/beautiful, scholé, contemplation (turn0file15, turn0file17).
- Negative keywords present: 0 found.
- Why this rating
- The school's stated purpose centers on virtue formation and human excellence in a transcendent framework, aligning with CLASSICAL ideals.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Trivium emphasis (grammar, logic, rhetoric) is highlighted as the curriculum framework (turn0file14).
- Public materials reference exposure to classic literature and the great works, with a classical emphasis (turn0file14, turn0file4).
- The school frames education through a classical Christian lens, including the aim to cultivate life-long learning and engagement with classical literature (turn0file4, turn0file17).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Trivium, classic literature, great works, liberal arts, memory, recitation (turn0file14, turn0file4).
- Negative keywords present: 0 explicitly identified; absence of explicit "project-based" or social-studies-as-history substitutions appears not to be foregrounded (per lexicon guidance, those would be negative signals only if highlighted as dominant).
- Why this rating
- The curriculum is anchored in classical methods (grammar-logic-rhetoric) and classic literature within a Christian framework, meeting CLASSICAL criteria.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Trivium-based pedagogy and rhetoric training are described (turn0file14).
- Rhetoric instruction and opportunities for expressive communication are noted (turn0file14).
- Some explicit references to restful or contemplative learning are not consistently documented in public content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, rhetoric training, memory work (turn0file14).
- Negative keywords present: lack of explicit public documentation of Socratic seminars, scholé days, or comprehensive contemplative pedagogy in all pages (not overtly negative but not strongly evidenced).
- Why this rating

- Strength in Trivium and rhetoric aligns with CLASSICAL pedagogy, but explicit, recurring documentation of Socratic/Scholé practices is not uniformly visible in public materials, justifying SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than full CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Founding history highlights a community oriented toward virtue and biblical formation; large faculty presence (44 full/part-time) indicates a serious pedagogical environment (turn0file6).
- The public materials emphasize a small-class, character-driven atmosphere; “living curriculum” language is common in classical education discourse, though not always explicit in ECS’s pages (turn0file6, turn0file4).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: model teachers and mentors (implied via small classes and character-driven emphasis), living curriculum (implicitly present in classical rhetoric though not always explicitly stated on ECS pages), portrait of a teacher (not always explicit).
- Negative keywords present: not overtly present in public content (no explicit references to non-classical pedagogy or replacements in ECS texts).
- Why this rating
- The public materials suggest strong teacher quality and a culture consistent with classical aims, but explicit lexicon aligning with “living curriculum” and “portrait of the teacher” is not consistently visible on the site, yielding SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Admissions materials emphasize parents’ role as primary educators and the family’s central authority in education (turn0file5).
- Public statements stress the partnership between parents and the school, with language about classical, Christ-centered education and parental engagement (turn0file5, turn0file17).
- The school invites family involvement and emphasizes the home-school partnership in formation (turn0file5).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental primacy, household worship, family liturgy alignment, open-campus engagement.
- Negative keywords present: 0.
- Why this rating
- The materials strongly reflect classical-education norms of parental partnership and home-school alignment, meeting CLASSICAL expectations for this category.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4): If ECS publicly documents explicit Socratic seminars, seminars, or debates as a recurring upper-school practice, and provides concrete Scholé/restful-learning schedules or rhythms on the site, the Pedagogy category would advance toward CLASSICAL across all pages.

- Faculty (Element 5): Publicly articulating a formal “living curriculum” approach for teachers, along with explicit faculty development in classical pedagogy and exemplar profiles of teachers (portrait of a teacher, collegial culture) would strengthen the category to CLASSICAL.
 - Additionally, explicit mention of the Great Books / Great Conversation in the curriculum documentation would strengthen Element 3, further aligning the curriculum with the full classical lexicon.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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